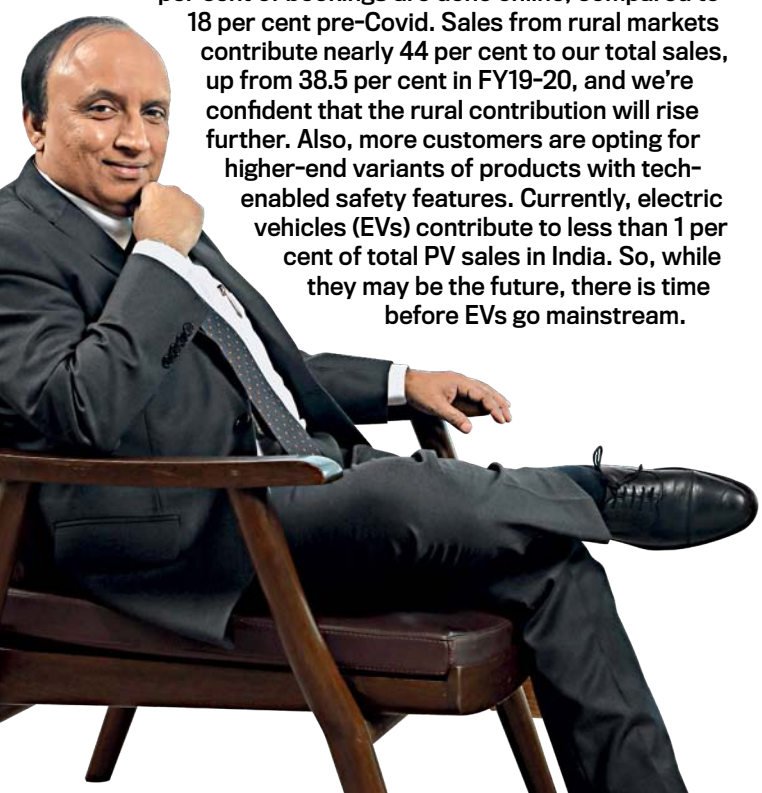
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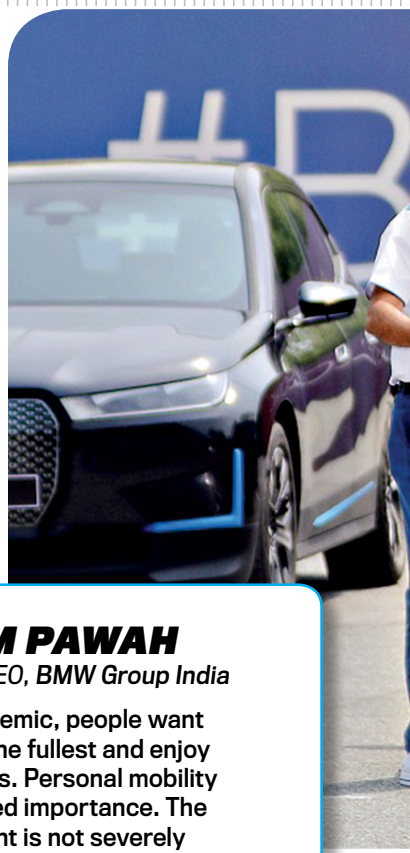
INDUSTRY LEADERS TALK ABOUT THE STATE OF THE AUTOMOTIVE MARKET POST THE COVID-19 PANDEMIC, THE SALES BOOM THIS FESTIVE SEASON, AND THE RURAL AND SEMI-URBAN SECTORS. WHAT ALSO STANDS OUT IS THE SHARP FOCUS ON THE ELECTRIC VEHICLE SEGMENT AND SAFETY FEATURES



SHASHANK SRIVASTAVA

Senior Executive Director, Marketing & Sales, Maruti Suzuki India Limited

Post-Covid, we witnessed an increased need for personal mobility. Currently, our pending orders are over 420,000 across our model range. Covid has also accelerated digitalisation and, today, over 28 per cent of bookings are done online, compared to 18 per cent pre-Covid. Sales from rural markets contribute nearly 44 per cent to our total sales, up from 38.5 per cent in FY19-20, and we're confident that the rural contribution will rise further. Also, more customers are opting for higher-end variants of products with tech-enabled safety features. Currently, electric vehicles (EVs) contribute to less than 1 per cent of total PV sales in India. So, while they may be the future, there is time before EVs go mainstream.



VIKRAM PAWAH

President & CEO, BMW Group India

Post the pandemic, people want to live life to the fullest and enjoy the best things. Personal mobility has also gained importance. The luxury segment is not severely impacted by mild inflation changes, but unpredictable socio-economic environment, Covid-19 and high taxation do affect consumer sentiment. Nonetheless, during the festive period, all brands–BMW, MINI and BMW Motorrad–saw good demand. We also expect EV contribution to rise to 10 per cent of overall sales. Good charging infrastructure and taxation benefits will drive market development.



TARUN GARG

Director, Sales, Service & Marketing, Hyundai Motor India Ltd

India saw a 40 per cent rise in purchase intent for personal vehicles post-Covid, and Hyundai sold a record 550,022 units in 2021. We're also committed to the Indian government's vision of electrification: last year, we announced a Rs 4,000 crore investment in R&D for a dedicated BEV Platform, E-GMP, and a line-up of six BEVs by 2028. In a collaborative step, Tata Power will instal fast chargers at HMIL's 34 EV dealer locations across 29 cities. We are also geared up to launch the IONIQ 5 EV next year.